From Open Source to Open Agency

Building Trust and Accountability in the Agentic AI Era

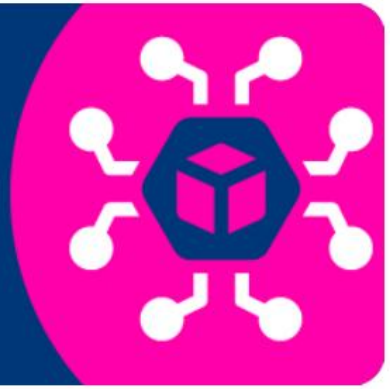
Anni Lai

Co-Chair, Generative AI Commons, LF AI & Data
Co-author, Enterprise Transitions to the Agentic Era
Board member, LF AI & Data
Advisory Board: LF Europe, LF Research, Kaiyuanshe, Advanced AI Society

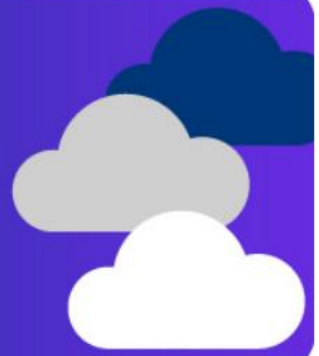
What the research found

25 participants. April–July 2026. Qualitative findings, not market estimates.

Model capability is no longer the gate; **trust, governance, and cost** now set the pace of enterprise agent adoption through 2030.



Agents are becoming an orchestration layer for the enterprise, an evolution in cloud architecture that enables greater coordination across existing systems.



As agents become more autonomous, **accountability for their errors remains with the organizations that deploy them** and the people who authorize their use.



Per-seat pricing is under pressure as agents reduce the number of people needed to do the work; pricing must shift toward usage or outcomes.



Put the control layer in early by placing a governance and observability gateway between agents and every model and tool they call.



Manage volatile token economics by metering usage at the gateway, so you can see which team and which workflow is spending what.



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Trust requires operational infrastructure

Page 2 infographic, remaining six findings



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AI agency changes the governance problem

Authority expands when an agent can act on systems and other people.

AI-generated contribution	Agent-executed action
Proposes code or an answer	Changes systems, data, or transactions
A person reviews the output	Controls validate authority before action
Quality and provenance need review	Permissions and agent handoffs need review

Human responsibility continues through review, authorization, oversight, and intervention.

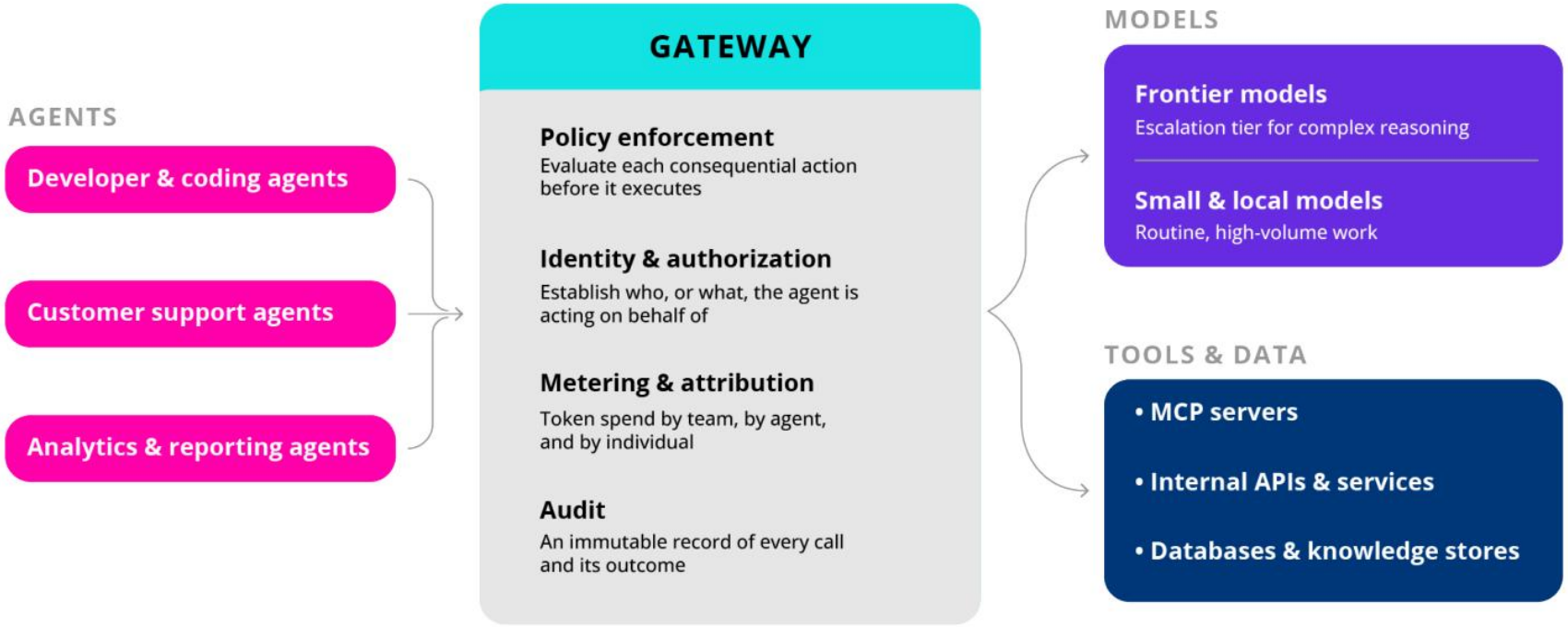
Accountable delegation

Every deployed agent should have a named human owner and bounded authority.

Governance question	Evidence the organization should maintain
Who authorized it?	Named owner and recorded approval
What may it do?	Allowed tools, data scope, and action limits
When must a person decide?	Approval thresholds and escalation conditions
How can we trace its actions?	Action records, outcomes, and agent handoffs
How can we stop it?	Revocable access and a tested intervention path

The control layer makes authority enforceable

Practitioners place governance and observability between agents and what they call.



Before action

Check identity, authority, and policy.

At runtime

Monitor calls, costs, and outcomes.

Guardrails need enforcement at runtime and at the tool boundary.

Open source foundations for trust

Interviewees emphasized interoperability, auditability, and sovereignty.

Interoperability	Common interfaces connect agents, tools, and organizations.
Auditability	Inspectable components support review and independent scrutiny.
Sovereignty	Enterprises retain choices about infrastructure and data control.

Enterprise readiness still requires data access, legacy integration, and investment in adoption.

Three layers of responsible agentic AI

A proposed framework for connecting openness with accountable AI agency

Layer	What it provides	A practical test
Open technology	Inspectable models, tools, and infrastructure	Can we inspect, integrate, and change the components?
Open governance	Shared standards, provenance, security, and policy controls	Can we verify authority and trace an action?
Human agency	Authorization, oversight, and the ability to intervene	Can an accountable person limit, override, or revoke it?

The layers work together: technical openness supports verification, and human authority gives governance its purpose.

Measuring responsible adoption

Governance should make successful deployment observable.

Evidence of value

Completed and accepted work
Resolution rate within agreed limits
Fully loaded cost per outcome

Evidence of control

Actions within delegated authority
Escalations and human review load
Traceable failures and interventions

The investment priority depends on the actual constraint:

trust, cost, data quality, integration, change management, or review capacity.

What must be open, verifiable, and governed for AI to remain worthy of human trust?

Clear human authority

Verifiable controls and action records

Shared foundations built through open collaboration

Openness supports transparency. Trust requires evidence and accountable people behind the system.



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